

Nineveh Was The New York City Of Its Day

Nineveh was the capital of a mighty empire. At the very height of its power and prosperity God raised up prophets to warn of impending judgments. God Himself described Nineveh as "that great city... (whose) wickedness is come up before me" (Jonah 1:2). Nahum called it: "the bloody city... full of lies and robbery" (Nahum 3:1).

Nineveh, like New York City, was comprised of four smaller cities or precincts. It spread some 30 miles in circumference and was protected by a 100 foot-high wall. The wall was wide enough for three chariots to run abreast on its roadway, and had 1,500 towers on it - each of them 250 feet tall.

In Jonah's day, Nineveh had 120,000 children under seven years old, so its total population had to be more than 600,000. In Nahum's time, it had a large standing army, powerful and undefeated. War horses paraded along its boulevards. Nineveh was a great merchant city, a world trade center. Three-fourths of the known world was under the sway of its power and commerce.

Under Jonah's preaching Nineveh had exhibited a form of repentance - but this repentance was shallow and short-lived. Nineveh soon returned to its wicked ways, and God was quickly forgotten. The city's wickedness and immorality were exported all over the world, and Nineveh and the Assyrian Empire began to flaunt their bloodshed. Thus God became enraged.

The Spirit of God came upon the prophet Nahum, and he declared this: "God is jealous... and is furious; the Lord will take vengeance: (Nahum 1:2). Nahum saw that wicked society -

drunk with pleasure, success and prosperity, full of pride, greed and violence, a people at ease while robbing and shedding blood - and he cried out, "Woe to Nineveh! God is going to bring judgment again!"

Nahum's prophecy came forth years after Jonah had been sent to proclaim judgment on the city. God had been "slow to anger" and patient in spite of their wickedness, bloodshed and godlessness. He remembered the short-lived repentance of their fathers under Jonah's preaching.

Nahum Anchored His Prophecy of Coming Destruction On The Revealed Word Of God

Nahum's prophecy was more than a dream or vision. Like Daniel and the other prophets,

Nahum was a student of the Word. He had studied the history of God's dealings with societies in the past, especially the great city of No-Amon (Thebes of Egypt).

No-Amon was the capital of the Egyptian empire during the imperial 18th to 20th Dynasties. Treasures poured into No-Amman's coffers from all over the world. It was the city of the Pharaohs. Temples to false gods lined its boulevards. Jeremiah prophesied against the city's idolatry: "Behold, I will punish the multitude of No, and Pharaoh, and Egypt, with their gods" (Jeremiah 46:25). Ezekiel, too, prophesied that God would "execute judgments in No... and... cut off the multitude of No" (Ezekiel 30:14,15).

No-Amon had been an impenetrable city, protected on all sides, "waters round about it, whose rampart was the sea, and her wall was from sea" (Nahum 3:8). The city was very prosperous and had added power from satellite

nations. "Ethiopia and Egypt were her strength... Put and Labium were thy helpers" (Nahum 3:9). No-Amon had almost the size and population of Nineveh before that city was wiped out in divine judgment. With its palaces, expensive art, exotic furniture, pottery and fine clothes, No-Amon was the envy of nations. It boasted a huge army and a great stockpile of weapons.

The world thought No was an invincible city in its time. they believed it would live forever.

"Yet was she (No) carried away, she went into captivity; her young children also were dashed in pieces at the top of all the streets: and they cast lots for her honorable men, and all her great men were bound in chains" (Nahum 3:10). Nahum prophesied this based on God's historical dealings with wicked societies in the past. "Art thou better than popular No?" (Nahum 3:8). In other words, "What makes you believe God will judge all others for the things

you are now doing but let you escape?"

God has every right to ask America the same question today. What is different about America from wicked Sodom? Are we better than Noah's generation? Or Lot's generation? Are we better than the wicked people of No-Amon? Are we more deserving that Nineveh, which God wiped out? considering all past evidences of God's fury, why should He spare us, since we are committing acts seven times worse than any of these wicked people?

Nahum's warning to Nineveh is a warning to us also: "Thou also shalt be drunken: thou shalt be hid" (Nahum 3:11). America is drunken with lust, drugs, violence, evil sex - and intoxicated with success and prosperity. "Thou shalt be hid" means this country will become powerless, reduced to nothing, unable to take action or to solve problems. Our mortal enemies will plunder us. Society will crumble under the weight of unsolvable problems.

Up to now America has stumbled along, enduring but never solving its problems. Yet we have survived. But now, all our problems are going to accelerate. The hospital system in our cities has become unmanageable: Addicts are slipping out of their rooms, running out to get crack, and then climbing back into bed. Many are freebasing cocaine in hospital rooms - even in emergency rooms. Doctors and nurses are being beaten and murdered. There is no cure, no solution possible!

Our jails are overflowing, resulting in the release of many criminals. We're now building prison barges in the attempt to cope with the overcrowding. Our penal institutions are horror houses of rape, violence and hopelessness. Here, too, there are no solutions, no cures in sight.

Our courts can't handle the caseloads anymore. Judge after judge has issued warnings: "We're on the brink of anarchy. we can't even process

the multitudes of criminals."

Our schools are the shame of the whole world. Inner-city school buildings are decaying; teachers live in fear. The schools have become a miniature hell where kids are confronted with guns, knives, drugs, violence and promiscuous sex. The schools are devoid of all morality.

Our welfare systems are in total chaos. New York State has called this city a "welfare basket case." Costs already have spun out of control.

Nobody in the U.S. Government, in Congress, on Wall Street or at the Federal Reserve can tell us what is happening to our economy. It is beyond us all. No one knows what is holding the system together.

**There is a Trigger That Has Set Off This
Awesome Judgment**

"There is one come out of thee, that imagineth evil against the Lord, a wicked counselor" (Nahum 1:11). God must pour out His fury when the nation turns from simply ignoring God to deliberately plotting against Him.

This evil one who plots against God - making laws, giving wicked counsel, designed to anger God - is the consensus, the national mind, expressed by its judges, courts, and government. This one who has arisen in our midst is embodied in our Supreme Court, our federal courts, our judges on every level. These people have become wicked counselors, waging war against God. And they have blood on their hands!

They are evil God-haters who protect baby-killers and atheistic rights. They have shaken their fist at God, daring Him to react to their flaunted rebellion. This small handful of wicked

counselors has set their hearts against God. They have declared war, and God no longer can hold back His fury.

I do not care a bit what the Supreme Court does, however, you see, God is going to turn it into a kangaroo court of fools." For now will I break His yoke from off thee, and will burst thy bonds in sunder" (Nahum 1:13). These wicked counselors will go down in judgment. God has promised to confound them and to make their faces black with fear.

Nahum asks, "Who can stand before his indignation? and who can abide (endure) in the fierceness of his anger?" (Nahum 1:6). when God's fury is on the land, when the fierceness of God's anger strikes, what judge can then stand in rebellion? What court will endure? God will smite them all with fear, striking their hearts with confusion. They will be helpless against the flood, crying, "What has happened?"

It's all going down!"

Four Specific Judgments God Inflicts On A Nation Going Down

Like Nineveh, America has an incurable wound. Other than a miracle of mercy, there is no more healing for us, only judgment (see Nahum 3:19). These judgments appear and quickly accelerate until each becomes an avalanche, an overwhelming flood (Nahum 1:18).

1. There shall be no end of corpses: The first judgment is that there will be "no end of corpses" Nahum 3:3 says, "There is a multitude of slain, and a great number of carcasses; and there is no end of their corpses; they stumble upon their corpses."

Nahum saw something that at the time seemed unbelievable. Nineveh was lounging comfortably in its prosperity. Its streets bustled with shoppers and merchants - business as usual. But the prophet saw a sword coming to those busy streets. He saw corpses lying everywhere, a multitude of the slain and murdered with people stumbling over the bodies. When judgment comes, expect to see caskets and corpses in growing numbers.

A terrible scene is emblazoned on my mind: that of former President Reagan and his wife weeping over the 250 caskets of soldiers who were blown up in Lebanon. And again I see them standing before empty caskets - those of five astronauts blown out of the sky. I see President Bush, too, standing gravely before some 35 caskets - those of sailors killed by a shipboard explosion. It's coffin time in America! In the days ahead there will be so many corpses that Americans will become immune to it all -

and will just step over bodies. One day we will see bodies dead from starvation on America's streets. Already AIDS victims are languishing on the streets with no place to die!

This story appeared in the news recently: A 14-year-old mother threw her newborn baby out of a fourth floor window. The little child's corpse was found three days later in the alley. People thought it was a discarded baby doll.

Another equally gruesome story is that of a three-day-old baby found in a dumpster on Ninth Avenue, wrapped in a plastic bag - just one of hundreds of little abandoned corpses found in the city.

But perhaps the most disturbing story to appear recently was that of the tiny corpse of a little girl who had been placed in a suitcase and burned to death. The story read, "She was abused and abandoned in life, but adopted and loved in death. She was a toddler, about three

years old, found burned to death in a suitcase dumped amid piles of trash in the vestibule of an apartment house."

"The body was going to be buried in Potters' Field, but the firefighters who found her were so broken by what they saw that they arranged - 'to give this baby some type of dignity in death - she probably didn't have much dignity in life'... Trucks from the engine and ladder company stood outside the church as (they) carefully cradled the tiny white casket in their arms and carried it into the church."

You can almost hear the frightful cry: "Come all ye gravediggers! Come, all ye coffin makers, labor around the clock. Come, ye pallbearers, the caskets keep coming! Come, ye funeral directors and embalmers, your work has just begun!" There is no end to the corpses!

What kind of spiritual blindness has fallen on us when we see this judgment all about and still

have preachers crying, "Peace! Prosperity!" Do they not care? Does it mean nothing to them?

2. Loss of national purpose: "I will shew the nations thy nakedness, and the kingdoms thy shame" (Nahum 3:5). The second judgment we'll see is the nations which once feared us, envied us and stood in awe of us will discover us to have become weak. "Behold, thy people in the midst of thee are women" (Nahum 3:13). In other words, "You have grown soft and effeminate through your luxury. You have no will, no resolve."

All dying empires become soft and effeminate, unwilling in the end to take a stand for anything. From Sodom to Babylon, dying empires have gone out drunk, lazy, stoned and immune to all warnings. Like Belshazzar, the king of Babylon who saw the writing on the wall, they end up giving the prophets their day in court - telling them, yes, they are on target, that what they're saying is all true. But then

they go right back to the party. (See Daniel 5).

"The gates of thy land shall be set wide unto thine enemies" (Nahum 3:13). Drug lords from Cambodia, Columbia, Mexico and Pakistan are laughing at our flimsy border patrols. God has torn down our walls. Castro has dumped hundreds of prisoners and spies on our land.

Thank God for the many good - even godly - aliens I've met. But for every good one, ten evil ones, including murderers and rapists, pour in. In many countries drug pushers are the only ones able to raise the money to come to America. The prophet said they came with a sword to kill and destroy.

3. A baptism of filth: "I will cast abominable filth upon thee, and make thee vile, and will set thee as a gazingstock" (Nahum 3:6). Our third judgment, like Nineveh, is that we have become the shame and disgrace of the world. The rest of the world blushes at our

wickedness. I once took visitors from Poland and other Soviet-bloc countries on a tour through New York's streets. As we walked down 42nd Street, I saw tears in their eyes. finally, one Polish businessman turned to me and said, "I'm walking through hell itself! Please take me out of here!"

"This is the rejoicing city that dwelt carelessly, that said in her heart, I am, and there is none beside me: how is she become a desolation, a place for beasts to lie down in! Every one that passeth by her shall hiss, and wag his hand" (Zephaniah 2:15). Israel once became so wicked that even the heathen "daughters of the Philistines... are ashamed of thy lewd way" (Ezekiel 16:47).

Moses warned Israel that sin would bring any nation "into desolation: and your enemies which dwell therein shall be astonished at it" (Leviticus 26:32).

America is now experiencing this supernatural baptism of filth. The prophet paints the picture of a God so furious, so full of vengeance, that He is throwing mud or dirt on this wicked nation. We are literally drowning in pornography: It is now a multi-million-dollar business. Ten years ago much of it was imported. But today the U.S. is the biggest exporter of filth in all the world.

With its television shows and VCR movies, our nation has developed an appetite for perversion and sadomasochism. Even daytime soap operas are full of smut, fornication and homosexuality. TV has become the open floodgate of this barrage of filth.

God is doing to America what He did to Israel after she lusted for flesh in the desert. "Ye shall not eat one day, not two days, nor five days... until it come out at your nostrils, and it be loathsome unto you" (Numbers 11:19-20).

The United States of America is now known as "the nation where anything goes!" There are virtually no more restraints. Young 11 and 12 year-old boys are becoming rapists. Girls are getting pregnant at age 12 - and then having abortions! Our nation plays the harlot while looking down the barrel of the deadly gun of AIDS, and laughs, "Who's afraid of AIDS?" Last week a movie star confessed that 12 of his best friends have died of AIDS. But he doesn't intend to change his ways!

4. A massive depression from which there is no escape: Many don't like to hear about the coming economic collapse. The word "depression" scares Americans. But believe it or not, we are not just facing another recession that will last a short while before the economy bounces back. Rather, we are facing the last great depression!

It happened to every past society and empire in the throes of judgment. Don't believe it won't

happen to us. Because of Israel's unfaithfulness, the Lord said to that nation: "Thou has multiplied thy merchants above the stars of heaven: the cankerworm spoileth, and fleeth away" (Nahum 3:16).

In this prophecy, the prophet Nahum was warning the city of an insidious enemy that would come to destroy its economy. Nineveh exported glassworks, textiles, carpets, ivory carvings, artwork of all kinds, gems, silver, gold and spices. Its merchants traveled throughout the world. But before long an invading cancer came, and enemies swooped down, spread themselves over the rich spoil and fled with the loot.

Rest assured the day is not far off when Japan, Taiwan, Korea and Germany will take their money from the United States and flee! "All they that look upon thee shall flee from thee, and say, Nineveh is laid waste; who will bemoan her? Whence shall I seek comforters

for thee?" (Nahum 3:7). "All that hear the bruit (news) of thee shall clap the hands over thee: for upon whom hath not thy wickedness passed continually?" (Nahum 3:19).

One day soon, Japan will quit buying our government bonds - as will all other nations. We will not be able to finance our massive debt. It will all tumble and fall. "He (God) hath caused thine enemy to rejoice over thee" (Lamentations 2:17).

The real estate market will crash as well. Zephaniah warned Nineveh; "Desolation shall be in the thresholds" (Zephaniah. 2:14). The thresholds represent dwellings. He prophesied of empty buildings with birds flying in and out of the shattered windows. "The bittern shall lodge in the upper lintels of it" (verse 14). The New American Standard Bible reads, "Birds will sing in the window."

Even now in Dallas, Houston and Denver we see

the appalling sight of empty skyscrapers: "A day of the trumpet against the high towers" (Zephaniah 1:16). High buildings, such as the Trump and Zeckendorf Towers in New York City represent the pride, competition and greed of American society. The day is coming when many of these towers will stand empty like giant, decaying tombstones, full of homeless people.

When Will All This Fall Upon Us?

Nahum said of Nineveh, "The Lord hath given a commandment concerning thee... will I cut off... for thou art vile" (Nahum 1:14). I believe God already has given the commandment to bring forth all these prophesied judgments. It all has been set in motion. The word I keep

hearing in my spirit is "acceleration". The fire has been ignited - and soon it will grow hotter, more intense and eventually will encompass all our society.

What about the people of God? What are we facing? Again, we are driven to the Word to find out what the Lord declared and performed in the past.

Has not God always delivered His people in past desolations? Let's search the Scriptures: Noah and his family escaped the flood. Were they preserved? Yes! Did Daniel and the Hebrew children survive the furnace and lion's den? Yes! Did Lot and those who heeded God's warnings perish in Sodom? No!

Didn't Jesus warn the Jews to flee Jerusalem when invading armies approached? He said, "When ye shall see Jerusalem compassed with armies... flee to the mountains... depart out; and let not them that are in the countries

enter" (Luke 21:20-21). And Jerusalem was destroyed while the obedient ones escaped - remembering the Lord's warning.

Even to the wicked Nineveh, for the sake of even one righteous man, God gave this glorious message: "The Lord is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble; and he knoweth them that trust in him" (Nahum 1:7). Those who listen and obey have always been saved!

His stronghold is a fortified house of rock: "In thee, O Lord, do I put my trust... Be thou my strong rock, for an house of defense to save me. For thou art my rock and my fortress" (Psalm 31:1-3).

And here is how we will be kept safe: "Into thine hand I commit my spirit: thou hast redeemed me, O Lord God of truth... Thou hast known my soul in adversities; and hast not shut me up in to the hand of the enemy; thou hast set my feet in a large room" (Psalm 31:5,7,8).

Prepare now for God's imminent judgments - by setting your heart on the Rock Who provided refuge for His own. Commit the keeping of your body soul to our gracious and merciful Lord.

How God intends to save His people in these troubled times, I do not know - but with Him nothing is impossible. He is our ark of safety, so we need not fear, or run, or hide. Even if we leave this world by way of a hydrogen meltdown, it will be instant deliverance from a world gone mad.

Call me a doomsayer - call me unpatriotic - call me any name you please. But I am already a citizen of another country - the New Jerusalem, which is above. We are supposed to be looking for a city whose builder and maker is God.

Finally, Jesus forewarned us of a day coming - so frightful, men's hearts would fail them for fear, beholding the horrors coming on the earth. Then He said, "Look up and rejoice, for

your redemption draws near."